



The Phoenix Landlord's Guide

7 Things to Know Before You Rent Out Your Arizona Home

A quick, practical rundown for Arizona owners weighing whether (and how) to rent out a property. No fluff, just what actually moves the numbers.

1. Price with data, not a guess

Overpricing is the most common and most expensive mistake. Weeks of vacancy cost far more than a small rent bump gains. Set the rent off current comps for your exact area and property type.

2. Screen every applicant the same way

Verify income (most owners look for ~3x the rent), credit, background, and rental history, applied equally to everyone under Fair Housing. One bad placement can erase a year of profit.

3. Know Arizona's rules

The Arizona Residential Landlord and Tenant Act governs deposits, required notices, and the eviction process. Small missteps get costly fast. (This guide isn't legal advice, talk to a pro for specifics.)

4. Budget for maintenance and reserves

Set aside roughly one month's rent per year for repairs. Arizona heat is brutal on HVAC, roofs, and exteriors, and fast repairs are what keep good tenants renewing.

5. Market where renters actually look

Syndicate to Zillow, Apartments.com, Zumper and the major portals with strong photos. Speed of lease-up is the single biggest driver of your annual return.

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6. Count the true cost of self-managing

Factor in your time, the 2am calls, legal exposure, vacancy, and turnover. A flat-fee manager often nets you more once mistakes and empty months are priced in.

7. Mind the tax angle

Track deductible expenses, management fees, repairs, depreciation, mileage, insurance. A CPA familiar with rentals usually pays for themselves. (Not tax advice.)

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